

[Summative #1]
[Perfect Paragraph - The Lottery]

Original Work

Thesis:

In Shirley Jackson's "The Lottery," Mr. Summers' words, actions, and thoughts reveal how the lottery influences their society's values, hinting to the darker side of human nature and characterization.

Paragraph:

Shirley Jackson's representation of the lottery and the black box reveal that the lottery has altered human perception of human lives and has shifted their values in order to benefit themselves. Mr. Summers, the person who conducts the lotteries, said that they should "better get started" and to "got this over with"(Jackson 10). This quote is significant because by rushing the ceremony, it shows how little respect that Mr. Summers has for other human lives. The lottery has been a tradition for many,many years. It is so old that people don't remember how the lottery was originally conducted. In fact, some places have even given up the lottery, symbolizing the lottery as an outdated tradition. Old Man Warner also demonstrates how the lottery shifts their values by saying "Lottery in June, corn be heavy soon"(Jackson 33). Dosen't this seem strange to you? Killing a person so that your harvest will be more fruitful? This shows how the societies in "The Lottery" which still perform the tradition of the lottery are prioritizing themselves over other people, even going as far as to kill other people over basic resources. It is clear from this that by controlling what people know, you can also control their actions. Shirley Jackson's "The Lottery" shows a society with a very dark tradition, revealing a darker side of humanity which prioritizes their own wellbeing over others.

Revised Work

Shirley Jackson's representation of the lottery and the black box reveal that the lottery has altered human perception of human lives and has shifted their values in order to benefit themselves. Mr. Summers, the person who conducts the lotteries, said that they should "better get started" and to "got this over with"(Jackson 10). This quote is significant because by rushing the ceremony, it shows how little respect that Mr. Summers has for other human lives. The lottery has been a tradition for many years, it is so old that people do not remember how the lottery was originally conducted. In fact, other towns have even given up the lottery, symbolizing the lottery as an outdated tradition. Old Man Warner also demonstrates how the lottery shifts their values by saying "Lottery in June, corn be heavy soon"(Jackson 33). This strange behavior, killing a person so that your harvest will be more fruitful? This shows how the societies in "The Lottery" which still perform the tradition of the lottery are prioritizing themselves over other people, even going

as far as to kill other people over basic resources. It says “corn be heavy soon”, which symbolizes a good harvest. It is clear from this that by controlling what people know, you can also control their actions and what they do. Shirley Jackson’s “The Lottery” shows a society with a very dark tradition, revealing a darker side of humanity which prioritizes their own wellbeing over others.